

THIS IS TECHNOLOGY, CULTURE AND SCIENCE WITH A DIFFERENCE, AND THAT DIFFERENCE IS USUALLY ENOUGH TO MAKE MOST NORMAL PEOPLE GO "WTF?"

This month in ALT:

This month, in Geek Key we look at some winners of the peculiar Ig Nobel Prize, we learn some important facts about COVID-19 in Infoporn, in 1000 words we look at some examples of microphotography and much more!



A nub's guide to F1

Following the release of Drive To Survive on Netflix, there is a surge of interest in F1, and although the events are currently cancelled, this is a quick and dirty primer on those who want to get into a new fandom.

<https://dgit.in/nubf1>

WHAT'S NEW

Gaben thinks we are close to realising the Matrix

Even as the surprise fourth installment of the Matrix franchise was in production, Gabe Newell, the CEO of Valve spoke about the future of entertainment in a rare interview with IGN, ahead of the Half Life: Alyx launch. Gaben is not even worried that most consumers around the world do not have the equipment needed to enjoy a VR game such as Half Life: Alyx, he has already set his eyes on the next level of immersive experiences, something that can simulate entire worlds using brain computer interfaces. "We're way closer to The Matrix than people realize," Gaben said. Apparently, Valve is in



talks with researchers into brain computer interfaces, and says that describing the technology is as difficult to explaining the internet to someone who hasn't experienced it before. When the

technology arrives, it will be an extinction level event for all other forms of entertainment, according to Gaben. He also said that anyone in the entertainment business is already thinking about it a lot, or will do so in the future. <https://dgit.in/gabematrix>

Strange forensic methods for solving real world crimes

This is about crime scenes with dead bodies, so this might have some graphic details. In the real world, there are some instances of bizarre forensic analysis. For example, after receiving a confession, the police uncovered a body encased in concrete, and experts drilled to the slab to collect various samples. A concrete expert was called in to analyse the various



particular mixes of concrete, and eventually the law enforcement officials could correlate a credit card receipt with the particular type of concrete surrounding the body. Another team used an entomologist, who was called in

to date a maggot infested body. The expert was able to identify to which stage the larvae had progressed to. In another case, police recovered a stolen car, but had no way to identify the thief. Within the car, was a mosquito though. The mosquito was trapped and sent to the laboratory, and after analysing the blood, the police found that they had the person in their databases.

<https://dgit.in/altforensics>



Gen X showing the way

While the media often throws around the word "millennial" to refer to young people, Gen X know their demographic, and are showing the world how to tackle the novel Coronavirus, because of their experience in technology and having to entertain and fend for themselves in isolation.

<https://dgit.in/genxcvd>



Tracking the Coronavirus

Kinsa Health has sold or given away over a million internet connected smart thermometers in the United States, which records instances of flu as soon as the consumers get to know. The data gathered by the company could now be tracking the spread of COVID-19.

<https://dgit.in/kinsacvd>



Hoarding in Fallout 76

Players in Fallout 76 are also hoarding virtual toilet paper rolls, which is a wasteland wide joke, a reaction to the panic buying seen in real stores. However, the hoarding has caused prices for the now rare and expensive commodity to go up, affecting the in game economy.

<https://dgit.in/fotp>